

ERICA SIETSEMA

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411 N. Ingalls St., Apt. 2
Ann Arbor, MI 48104

November 4, 2025

Ford Robotics Building
2505 Hayward St.
Ann Arbor, MI 48109

Dear College of Engineering Robotics Representative:

I am writing to apply for the Applications Programmer Associate position available in the College of Engineering Robotics department. I am very interested in working with you to deliver technologies to researchers and students using software in the College of Engineering Robotics department. I am confident that my background in Helpdesk and Project Management makes me particularly well suited for this opportunity.

I have held multiple jobs that have allowed me to learn Project Management over my years of working at Waymo. While I worked at Waymo I was tasked to create kanban boards that implemented an agile style of productivity for the software quality team there. Using JIRA and agile I was able to bring about a transformation to the way work was performed which helped meet our production goals and kept us on track to hit our SLAs for team output. It was there I learned that project management involved creating systems that create a foolproof way to hit goals.

In addition to my knowledge of Project Management I am also knowledgeable about software interfaces used at the University of Michigan, and particularly the Computer Science department. During my time as a computer technician within the EECS department at the University of Michigan I was tasked with the installation and maintenance of many software tools for the many research computers which led me to understand the complexities of the software needed to conduct research productively.

I believe my unique combination of skills and experience makes me a great fit for University of Michigan Robotics. I appreciate your time and consideration, and I look forward to discussing my qualifications with you further during an interview.

Sincerely,

Erica Sietsema

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EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science

April 2018

Coursework: Data Structures and Algorithms, Introduction to Computer Security, Mobile App Development for Entrepreneurs, Web Systems, Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Introduction to Cryptography

EXPERIENCE

Waymo via TaskUs, Novi, MI

Autonomous Vehicle Support Specialist

August 2025-October 2025

- Created bug reports and feature requests for autonomous vehicle fleet support software to ensure the suite of software used to assist the autonomous fleet was valid
- Collaborated with engineering teams to test autonomous vehicles in real life driving scenarios on training roads
- Provided tier-2 support to autonomous fleet vehicles to help guide autonomous vehicles through challenging situations and ensure safe navigation

May Mobility, Ann Arbor, MI

Tele-Assist Operator

September 2024-November 2024

- Utilized Linux programming to help capture data associated with autonomous vehicle performance and report it to engineers
- Collaborated closely with engineers to help guide vehicles around obstacles and trouble-shoot vehicle misbehavior
- Communicated with vehicle drivers to assist the operations of autonomous vehicles safely on public roads

Waymo via Cognizant, Southfield, MI

Senior Process Executive-Data

September 2021-January 2024

- Owned the sign-off of the test results on scenario test cases, and analyzed and provided reports on the results which resulted in bringing software components of the AV system to a production-ready state
- Created and maintained scenario-based test sets that tested different parts of the AV's system and allowed for continuous integration of new software features within the AV's modules
- Worked with engineers to create and execute test plans for different parts of the autonomous vehicle's autonomy stack including perception, prediction, motion planning, localization, and controls

University of Michigan, Lurie Nanofabrication Facility, Ann Arbor, MI

Stockkeeper

May 2021-October 2021

- Responsible for fulfilling lab orders from lab inventory and directing the lab store
- Trained and supervised undergraduate lab assistants

- Created database of lab inventory and spreadsheets to better facilitate ordering of lab supplies
- Tracked inventory in database and did hard counts of lab supplies accounting for any discrepancies in database and stock

University of Michigan, College of Engineering, Ann Arbor, MI

Computer Technician

October 2016-March 2017

- Hardware operations (machine builds, server dismantling, hard drive wipes, etc).
- Utilized MySQL and DNS to record department machines.
- Installed/manipulated software across multiple platforms (MATLAB, Microsoft Office, Adobe Acrobat)..
- Experience with multiple OS installations (Linux-based systems, OSX, Windows, Redhat).

SKILLS

Computer: Microsoft Office, Excel, Outlook, Google Workspace, C++, C, Python,, MySQL, Agile, Kanban, Confluence, Linux/Ubuntu, ChromeOS, JIRA, Confluence